TOBI ADEFIDIYA

NARRATIVE DESIGNER | STORY & GAME DESIGN

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Portfolio link | **LinkedIn**

OVERVIEW

My name is Tobi, and I am a **narrative and game designer** who loves bringing characters and their worlds to life. My work connects character-driven stories, **dialogue and environmental storytelling** with gameplay, using game engines such as Unity to prototype and implement my ideas. I enjoy collaborating across disciplines and refining player experiences through **playtesting**, with experience spanning narrative, **combat and systems design**, team leadership and production.

I am currently pursuing a master's in Games Design & Development at the University of Southern California. I hold a **First Class Honours** bachelor's degree in Games Design & Art from the University of Southampton and am a **PlayStation Career Pathways Scholar**.

SELECTED NARRATIVE & GAME DESIGN PROJECTS

Full Court Uprising! | 2026

Lead Narrative Designer | USC Radical Play Lab

- Lead story development within an approximately **24-person team**, shaping the narrative backbone, central threat, **character arcs** and emotional beats.
- Write **dialogue** and define character personalities and motivations to establish **distinct voices** and support character development.
- Guide **narrative direction** and maintain cohesion between story beats and gameplay systems.

Strife & Serenity | 2024 - Present

Solo Developer | Narrative, Combat, Systems & Level Design

- Authored the **lore, dialogue and character biographies** for a narrative-driven action RPG about conflict, peace and resistance to change; shaped the protagonist's emotional journey.
- Built the original **playable prologue** over four months in Unity using **Visual Scripting** and custom C#; showcased it at the John Hansard Gallery in Southampton, UK.
- Designed **objective and level flow** across exploration, rooftop traversal and a climactic duel; used optional letters, journals and environmental clues to reveal world context.
- Designed and implemented the **three-level Arcane Gauge**, elemental abilities and vulnerabilities, ability hotbar and Marks reinforcement system.
- Tuned **combat rules** including parries, dodges, guard breaks, stamina, cooldowns, damage and status effects to support player decision-making.
- Used **playtests and design documentation** to refine emotional pacing and player comprehension; implemented music transitions and expressive dialogue portraits.

Cthulhu's Cat Sitter | 2023

Team Lead / Designer / Writer / Systems Designer | PC

- **Led the team project** and designed five escalating nights of horror puzzles, survival and exploration; created scenes, sets and a PSX-inspired visual filter.
- Scripted story beats and **branching good/bad endings**; documented systems, level flows and interactions in the game design document.
- Recommended a **PC-only pivot** when technical complexity threatened scope, focusing the team on a more achievable platform target.

TEAM PRODUCTION & AUDIO

ORUU

Producer | USC Narrative Play Team Project

- Coordinated a narrative adventure about restoring sound to a silent world; aligned responsibilities with team strengths and tracked **deliverables and milestones**.
- Ran check-ins, surfaced blockers and **prioritized scope** around sound interactions and companionship; supported QA and iteration cycles.

Pulse & Pole | 2026

Audio / Sound Design | Four-Person Team | PSCP Ratchet Up

- Created **SFX** by layering, editing and combining sourced sounds in **Audacity**; collaborated on background music and player-input beats for rhythm-based gameplay.

EXPERIENCE

USC | Teaching Assistant, Interactive Media & Game Design | 2025 - Present
Support game design, **Unity prototyping** and narrative instruction; critique student projects and facilitate playtests.

3Dami Animation Summer Camps | Participant | 2019 & 2021
Collaborative 3D animation and short-film production in Blender through a programme supported by UCL, The Mill and Blue Zoo (2019), and ScreenSkills and ACCESS:VFX (2021). Historical supporters include DNEG, Framestore and Rare.

The Creative Pulse | Design Intern | 2018
Assisted branding for clients including McCoy and Evian; created cover and packaging mockups with senior designers.

ADDITIONAL PROJECTS

Stonespoke | Programmer | 2025
Built **color-based riddle logic** and environment reset behavior in custom C# for a puzzle game about uncertainty and discovery.

Mark of Mastery | Lead Designer / Developer | 2023
Prototyped **combat loops**, exploration and environmental storytelling for the foundation of Strife & Serenity.

EDUCATION & INDUSTRY DEVELOPMENT

University of Southern California | M.S., Game Design & Development
2025 - Present | Expected graduation: 2027

University of Southampton | B.A., Game Design & Art
Graduated 2024 | **First Class Honours**

East Surrey College | Creative Media Production | 2021 | Distinction

PlayStation Career Pathways Scholar | 2025 - Present
Gerald A. Lawson USC Games Fund scholarship recipient; PSCP Summit, San Mateo, July 2026.

DESIGN & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design: Narrative/story, combat, systems, gameplay, levels, quest/objective progression, puzzles, branching ending design and playtest iteration.

Development: Unity, **Visual Scripting**, C#, Git, Visual Studio.

Design & production: Game design documentation, Excel/Google Sheets, Trello, Notion, PowerPoint.

Creative tools: Blender, Photoshop, Illustrator, Clip Studio Paint, Audacity, Mixamo.